

Alignment of the Canadian Language Benchmarks to the Global Scale of English: Stage I Basic

November 2024

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About the GSE

Pearson developed the Global Scale of English (GSE) to provide instructors and learners with a more detailed understanding of English language proficiency. It has been designed to build learners' confidence by revealing exactly where they are on their learning journey and setting personalised goals to help them progress.

The GSE is an ecosystem that underpins the Pearson English Journey:

- **GSE Scale:** a proficiency scale from 10 to 90.
- **GSE Learning Objectives:** descriptions of what learners can do at each level of proficiency in speaking, listening, reading, and writing.
- **Courseware:** all of Pearson's English language learning courseware is developed using the GSE Learning Objectives.
- **Assessment:** institutions can develop their own assessment materials using the GSE Learning Objectives and Assessment Frameworks or choose one of Pearson's digital assessments which report on the GSE.

The GSE is the result of many years of research with more than 6,000 teachers from over 50 countries. It serves as a standard against which English language courses and assessments worldwide can be benchmarked.

The GSE has been psychometrically aligned to the Common European Framework of Reference or CEFR (see De Jong, Mayor, & Hayes, 2016). It complements and extends the CEFR by adding an extra layer of detail to the CEFR levels and providing thousands of additional learning objectives. This extra information helps learners understand where they are now and offers a step-by-step guide to where they want to go next. Using the GSE, teachers can match a student to course materials to suit their exact level and learning goals.

CEFR level	GSE Scale
Below A1	10–21
A1	22–29
A2	30–35
A2+ ('plus level')	36–42
B1	43–50
B1+ ('plus level')	51–58
B2	59–66
B2+ ('plus level')	67–75
C1	76–84
C2	85–90

Table 1: The relationship between the GSE and the CEFR

To address the specific needs of learners studying English for different purposes, GSE Learning Objectives have been developed for five different learner audiences:

- **adult:** adults studying on a general English course
- **academic:** adults studying academic English
- **professional:** adults studying English for the workplace
- **young learner:** English language learners aged 6–14
- **pre-primary:** English language learners aged 3–5

For more information:

[pearson.com/languages/why-pearson/the-global-scale-of-english](https://www.pearson.com/languages/why-pearson/the-global-scale-of-english)

About Canadian Language Benchmarks

For the purposes of this alignment, we worked with the 2012 edition of *Canadian Language Benchmarks: English as a Second Language for Adults*. The Canadian Language Benchmarks (CLB) are written as 12 benchmarks along a continuum from basic to advanced. These 12 benchmarks are then organised into three stages, each associated with a degree of complexity and demand.

This report looks at the four benchmarks in Stage I – Basic Language Ability:

“Basic language ability encompasses abilities that are required to communicate in common and predictable contexts about basic needs, common everyday activities and familiar topics of immediate personal relevance. In the CLB, these are referred to as non-demanding contexts of language use.” (CLB, p10)

Stage I – Basic Language Ability

Benchmark and Ability Level	Listening	Speaking	Reading	Writing
CLB 1: Initial CLB 2: Developing CLB 3: Adequate CLB 4: Fluent	Interpreting simple spoken communication in routine, non-demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas.	Creating simple spoken communication in routine, non-demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas.	Interpreting simple written communication in routine, non-demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas.	Creating simple written communication in routine, non-demanding contexts of language use within the four Competency Areas.

Table 2: Stage I – Basic Language Ability (CLB, p11)

For each language skill, there are four broad representative competency areas: Interacting with others, Instructions, Getting things done, Sharing information.

Alignment Methodology and Results

Each Canadian Language Benchmark competency statement within each competency area was aligned to one or more GSE Learning Objectives. The profile of ability, sample indicators of ability and sample tasks were also consulted during the alignment. Given that the target audience for CLBs is adult learners, GSE Learning Objectives for Adults, Professionals and Academic were used.

The results of the GSE alignment show consistency with the CEFR-CLB alignment carried out by North and Piccardo in 2018.

Stage	CLB level	GSE range	CEFR-CLB alignment (North & Piccardo)
I: Basic	1	10-19	<A1
	2	20-27	A1
	3	28-34	A1/A2
	4	35-41	A2/A2+
II: Intermediate	5	42-46	B1
	6	47-52	B1/B1+
	7	53-58	B1+
	8	59-66	B2
III: Advanced	9	67-72	B2+
	10	73-78	C1
	11	79-84	C1
	12	85-90	C2

Table 3: CLB-GSE alignment compared to CLB-CEFR

Stage I – Benchmark 1

Listening

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand individual greetings, introductions and goodwill expressions.	Can recognise simple informal greetings.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can recognise a few familiar everyday words, if delivered slowly and clearly.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can understand basic personal details if given carefully and slowly.	21	Below A1 (10-21)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand very short, simple instructions, commands and requests related to immediate personal needs.	Can understand cardinal numbers from 1 to 20.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can understand the letters of the alphabet.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can recognise the letters of the English alphabet when pronounced.	11	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can understand very basic common classroom instructions.	16	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can understand cardinal numbers from 21 to 100.	19	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can understand basic questions about personal details if addressed slowly and clearly.	21	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can distinguish between 'can' and 'can't'.	24	A1 (22-29)
III. Getting things done	Understand expressions used to attract attention and to request assistance in situations of immediate personal need.	Can understand some basic words and phrases to show politeness (e.g. 'Please', 'Thank you', 'Excuse me', 'Sorry').	11*	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can recognise familiar words in short phrases and sentences spoken slowly and clearly, if supported by pictures.	19	Below A1 (10-21)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand very simple information about highly familiar, concrete topics.	Can understand the time of day when expressed in full hours.	18	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can recognise basic time words (e.g. days, months) in simple phrases or sentences.	19	Below A1 (10-21)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Use and respond to basic courtesy formulas and greetings.	Can greet people using a few basic fixed expressions.	12	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can use a few basic words and phrases to show politeness (e.g. 'please', 'thank you').	12	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can establish basic social contacts with simple, polite greetings and farewells.	19	Below A1 (10-21)
II. Giving instructions	Give brief, simple, common, routine instructions to a familiar person.	Can ask very simply for repetition when they don't understand.	21	Below A1 (10-21)
III. Getting things done	Make and respond to simple requests related to immediate personal needs (such as asking for assistance, or for the time, a price or an amount).	Can make simple purchases by pointing or other gestures.	11	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can name a few very common everyday objects.	12	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can ask and answer basic requests for information with 'What's this/that?'	16	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can tell the time of day in full hours.	16	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can use some very basic words to ask for food and drink.	17	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can ask about the price of something.	19	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can ask for and give the day and date.	19	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can say a range of basic numbers, quantities and prices.	20	Below A1 (10-21)
IV. Sharing information	Give basic personal information in response to direct questions from a supportive listener.	Can introduce themselves using a basic phrase (e.g. 'My name's ...').	12	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can read out phone numbers.	13	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can spell out their own name and address.	14	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can give very limited personal information using basic fixed expressions.	16	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can say what they do (e.g. name of their job, student).	19	Below A1 (10-21)
	Ask for basic personal information.	Can ask someone for their name.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can ask someone what their nationality is.	13	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can say their own age and ask someone about their age.	18	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can ask someone what their job is.	19	Below A1 (10-21)

Reading

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand short greetings and simple goodwill messages .	Can recognise different basic words or phrases used for a similar purpose (e.g. hi / hello) to greet someone.	18*	Below A1 (10-21)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand very short, simple instructions for common, familiar everyday situations.	Can understand very short, simple, instructions on everyday signs (e.g. 'No parking', 'No food or drink').	20*	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can understand basic written instructions for classroom activities (e.g. 'Read and match').	23*	A1 (22-29)
III. Getting things done	Get information from very short, simple, common formatted texts (such as simple sections of forms, maps, diagrams, sales receipts, or common universal traffic signs and civic symbols).	Can read and understand simple prices.	12	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can recognise familiar names, words and very basic phrases on simple notices.	15	Below A1 (10-21)
IV. Comprehending information	Recognize names, numbers and some basic details in very simple, short texts related to everyday situations and immediate needs.	Can recognise cardinal numbers up to 10.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can recognise the letters of the alphabet.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can identify very common food and drink on a menu.	14	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can recognise basic plural forms of nouns (e.g. cars, books).	14	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can understand basic sentences introducing someone (e.g. name, age).	18	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can recognise cardinal numbers from 11-100.	22	A1 (22-29)
		Can understand basic sentences describing everyday objects (e.g. colour, size), given visual support.	23	A1 (22-29)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Writing

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Convey greetings or other goodwill messages by completing cards or other very short, simple standard texts.	Can post simple online greetings, using basic formulaic expressions and emoticons.	16	Below A1 (10-21)
II. Reproducing information	Copy numbers, letters, words, short phrases or sentences from simple lists or very short passages, for personal use or to complete short tasks.	Can list names, numbers, prices and very simple information from texts that are of immediate interest, that are composed in very simple language and contain illustrations.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can write the letters of the alphabet in upper and lower case.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can write cardinal numbers from 1 to 20 as words.	12	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can copy familiar words and short phrases about everyday objects and set phrases.	18	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can signal the end of a sentence using a full stop.	19*	Below A1 (10-21)
III. Getting things done	Complete very short, simple or simplified forms that require only basic personal identification information.	Can write their name, address and nationality.	10	Below A1 (10-21)
IV. Sharing information	Write a few words to complete a short, guided text or answer simple questions to describe a personal situation.	Can write a few basic sentences introducing themselves (e.g. name, age, where they are from), given prompts or a model.	24	A1 (22-29)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Stage I – Benchmark 2

Listening

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand greetings, introductions, requests, goodwill expressions and an expanding range of basic courtesy formulas.	Can recognise simple formal greetings.	13	Below A1 (10–21)
		Can understand the main information when people introduce themselves (e.g. name, age, where they are from).	22	A1 (22–29)
		Can recognise basic information when people introduce themselves in work-related situations (name, job, etc).	26	A1 (22–29)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand short, simple, common instructions, commands, requests and directions related to immediate personal needs.	Can understand ordinal numbers from 1 to 100.	20	Below A1 (10–21)
		Can understand short, simple instructions addressed carefully and slowly.	23	A1 (22–29)
		Can understand simple spoken commands in a game or sport.	26	A1 (22–29)
		Can understand simple directions from X to Y on foot or public transport.	26	A1 (22–29)
III. Getting things done	Understand expressions used to make and respond to requests and warnings in situations of immediate personal need.	Can understand questions addressed carefully and slowly.	23	A1 (22–29)
		Can distinguish between ‘can’ and ‘can’t’.	24	A1 (22–29)
		Can understand excuses if expressed in simple language.	30	A2 (30–35)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand simple information about familiar, concrete topics.	Can understand simple language related to prices and quantities.	20	Below A1 (10–21)
		Can recognise basic factual information about times and dates.	25	A1 (22–29)
		Can understand basic factual statements.	26	A1 (22–29)
		Can recognise key information (e.g. place, time) about everyday events, if spoken slowly and clearly.	26	A1 (22–29)
		Can recognise words and simple phrases related to familiar topics, if spoken slowly and clearly and supported by pictures.	26	A1 (22–29)
		Can recognise familiar key words and phrases in short, basic descriptions (e.g. of objects, places or people), if spoken slowly and clearly.	27	A1 (22–29)
		Can understand basic information about prices, times, and dates in familiar contexts, if spoken slowly and clearly.	27	A1 (22–29)
		Can extract key factual information such as prices, times and dates from short clear, simple announcements.	30	A2 (30–35)
		Can recognise phrases and content words related to basic personal and family information.	30	A2 (30–35)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Use and respond to courtesy formulas and greetings.	Can greet people, ask how they are and react to news.	24	A1 (22-29)
		Can introduce themselves, their hobbies and interests in a basic way.	26	A1 (22-29)
		Can introduce someone in a basic way, giving their name and job title.	26	A1 (22-29)
		Can introduce people using basic language.	27	A1 (22-29)
		Can make an introduction and use basic greeting and leave-taking expressions.	28	A1 (22-29)
II. Giving instructions	Give short, simple, common, routine instructions to a familiar person.	Can ask for simple directions, referring to a map or plan.	29	A1 (22-29)
		Can give simple classroom instructions.	31	A2 (30-35)
III. Getting things done	Make and respond to simple requests related to common everyday activities.	Can ask where other people are in a limited way.	20	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can ask and answer simple questions about things they have in a limited way.	21	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can give basic information about the price of something.	23	A1 (22-29)
		Can agree to simple requests using a few basic fixed expressions.	24	A1 (22-29)
		Can ask for a drink or food in a limited way.	24	A1 (22-29)
		Can buy tickets on public transport using basic fixed expressions.	24	A1 (22-29)
		Can ask and answer simple questions in areas of immediate need or on very familiar topics.	25	A1 (22-29)
		Can make a few basic requests related to immediate personal needs (e.g. 'Can I have a pen, please?').	26	A1 (22-29)
		Can check into a hotel using a few basic fixed expressions.	26	A1 (22-29)
		Can accept offers using basic fixed expressions.	27	A1 (22-29)
		Can ask people for things and give people things.	28	A1 (22-29)
	Give very simple warnings and cautions.	Can give a simple warning of immediate danger using a fixed expression.	25*	A1 (22-29)
		Can ask for help using basic fixed expressions.	27	A1 (22-29)
		Can ask for attention.	29	A1 (22-29)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
IV. Sharing information	Give expanded basic personal information to a supportive listener.	Can introduce themselves in a basic way, giving some information about where they live, their family etc.	22	A1 (22-29)
		Can ask and answer basic questions about family and friends in a limited way.	22	A1 (22-29)
		Can give key information to introduce themselves (e.g. name, age, where they are from).	23	A1 (22-29)
		Can describe where they live.	26	A1 (22-29)
		Can express ability or lack of ability with regard to basic activities using 'can' or 'can't'.	27	A1 (22-29)
		Can express preferences about food and drink using basic fixed expressions.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can describe a person's likes and dislikes using simple language.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can exchange personal details (e.g. where they live, things they have).	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can answer simple questions about their daily activities or routines, given a model.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can express how they are feeling using very basic fixed expressions.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can answer simple questions about habits and routines.	29	A1 (22-29)
		Can talk about the family in a basic way, given prompts.	29	A1 (22-29)
	Ask for basic personal information.	Can ask for and give a date of birth.	20	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can ask for the spelling of a word, or for a word to be written down.	22	A1 (22-29)
		Can ask simple questions about other people (e.g. their name, age, where they live, things they have).	27	A1 (22-29)
		Can ask and answer simple questions about people they know in a limited way.	28	A1 (22-29)
	Give basic descriptions of concrete, familiar objects in a few short words or phrases.	Can name very common forms of transport.	17	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can use a few simple words to describe objects (e.g. colour, number), if supported by pictures.	18	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can describe objects in a basic way (e.g. colour, size).	24	A1 (22-29)
		Can ask basic questions about objects (e.g. colour, size).	26	A1 (22-29)

Reading

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand short greetings and other goodwill messages.	Can understand short, simple messages about when and where to meet.	28	A1 (22-29)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand short, simple, clearly sequenced instructions for common, familiar everyday situations.	Can follow short, simple written directions (e.g. to go from X to Y).	26	A1 (22-29)
		Can follow basic instructions for making something simple.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can follow simple instructions to carry out a straightforward task.	29	A1 (22-29)
III. Getting things done	Get information from simple formatted texts (such as simple forms, maps, diagrams, signs, labels, tables and schedules).	Can recognise familiar names, words and very basic phrases on simple notices and signs.	19*	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can understand a simple travel itinerary, including places, dates, and times.	24	A1 (22-29)
		Can understand a simple timesheet.	25	A1 (22-29)
		Can understand simple phrases related to familiar, everyday activities.	29	A1 (22-29)
	Get basic information from short, simple business or service notices.	Can understand short written notices, signs and instructions with visual support.	27	A1 (22-29)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand the purpose and some basic details in very simple, short texts related to everyday, familiar, personally relevant situations and topics.	Can recognise cardinal numbers from 11-100.	22	A1 (22-29)
		Can understand short, simple descriptions of objects, people and animals, given visual support.	25	A1 (22-29)
		Can understand basic phrases in short, simple texts.	27	A1 (22-29)
		Can extract personal details in a limited way.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can understand basic factual statements relating to pictures or simple texts.	29	A1 (22-29)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Writing

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Convey an expanding range of goodwill messages (such as thanks, apologies, congratulations, get well wishes, goodbyes, and sympathy) by means of standard cards or guided notes.	Can write some basic words and phrases to show politeness (e.g. 'Please', 'Thank you').	21*	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can formulate very simple messages and personal online postings as a series of very short sentences about hobbies, likes/dislikes, etc., relying on the aid of a translation tool.	25	A1 (22-29)
		Can spell a range of common greetings.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can write a standard greeting on a card.	31	A2 (30-35)
II. Reproducing information	Copy a range of information, from simple lists or very short passages, for personal use or to complete short tasks.	Can list names, numbers, prices and very simple information of immediate interest in oral texts, provided the articulation is very slow and clear, with repetition.	22	A1 (22-29)
		Can copy short sentences on everyday subjects (e.g. directions how to get somewhere).	24	A1 (22-29)
		Can copy out single words and short texts presented in standard printed format.	25	A1 (22-29)
		Can use basic punctuation (e.g. commas, full stops, question marks).	26	A1 (22-29)
		Can write dates using both digits and words.	28	A1 (22-29)
III. Getting things done	Complete short, simple or simplified forms that require only basic personal identification or familiar information.	Can complete a very simple online purchase or application, providing basic personal information (e.g. name, e-mail or telephone number).	22	A1 (22-29)
		Can complete simple forms with basic personal details.	23	A1 (22-29)
		Can complete a simple form requiring travel information (e.g. landing card, customs declaration).	27	A1 (22-29)
IV. Sharing information	Write a few words to complete a short, guided text or answer simple questions to describe a personal situation.	Can write consistently with joined-up letters.	20	Below A1 (10-21)
		Can write basic sentences describing everyday objects (e.g. colour, size), given a model.	26	A1 (22-29)
		Can write simple sentences about their family and where they live.	27	A1 (22-29)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Stage I – Benchmark 3

Listening

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand simple social exchanges, including styles of greetings, introductions and leave-taking.	Can understand basic information about someone when introduced to them using simple language.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can follow short, simple social exchanges.	33	A2 (30-35)
		Can recognise simple, fixed expressions used in small talk.	34	A2 (30-35)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand instructions and directions related to familiar, everyday situations of immediate personal relevance.	Can understand simple directions, if spoken slowly and clearly.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can understand the main information in short, simple dialogues about familiar activities, if spoken slowly and clearly.	33	A2 (30-35)
		Can identify key information (e.g. places, times) from short audio recordings, if spoken slowly and clearly.	33	A2 (30-35)
		Can understand simple requests or instructions to carry out concrete work-related tasks.	34	A2 (30-35)
III. Getting things done	Understand expressions used in familiar everyday situations (such as requests, permission and warnings).	Can understand basic questions about free time activities.	27	A1 (22-29)
		Can understand basic information about free time activities.	27	A1 (22-29)
		Can understand key information about arrangements in simple dialogues spoken slowly and clearly.	32	A2 (30-35)
		Can understand simple, everyday conversations if conducted slowly and clearly.	33	A2 (30-35)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand short, simple, descriptive communication about a person, object, situation, scene, personal experience or daily routine.	Can identify common objects from spoken descriptions, if spoken slowly and clearly.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can identify key words and phrases in descriptions of someone's appearance and clothes.	31	A2 (30-35)
		Can identify basic factual information in short, simple dialogues or narratives on familiar everyday topics, if spoken slowly and clearly.	32	A2 (30-35)
		Can understand the main information in simple conversations about hobbies and interests.	34	A2 (30-35)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Use a range of courtesy formulas and greetings in very short, casual, face-to-face interactions.	Can exchange personal details (e.g. where they live, things they have).	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can respond politely when introduced to someone, using a few basic fixed expressions.	29	A1 (22-29)
		Can give a short description of their home, family and job, given some help with vocabulary.	30	A2 (30-35)
		Can initiate and respond to simple statements on very familiar topics.	30	A2 (30-35)
		Can talk about everyday things (e.g. people, places, job, study) in a basic way.	31	A2 (30-35)
		Can ask someone about their hobbies and activities using simple language.	31	A2 (30-35)
		Can start or end a short conversation using basic fixed expressions.	32	A2 (30-35)
		Can ask others if they can do everyday activities using simple language, given a model.	32	A2 (30-35)
		Can introduce themselves on the phone and close a simple call.	33	A2 (30-35)
		Can talk about their life (e.g. family, home, job), using simple language.	33	A2 (30-35)
		Can take part in a very simple conversation on a familiar topic if the other speaker repeats questions and answers as necessary and speaks slowly and clearly.	34	A2 (30-35)
		Can show understanding using a limited range of fixed expressions.	34	A2 (30-35)
II. Giving instructions	Give simple, common, routine instructions and directions to a familiar person.	Can give very simple instructions to a co-operative group given help with formulation when necessary.	32	A2 (30-35)
		Can ask for simple directions from X to Y on foot or by public transport.	32	A2 (30-35)
		Can give simple directions using a map or plan.	32	A2 (30-35)
		Can give simple directions from X to Y on foot or by public transport.	34	A2 (30-35)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
III. Getting things done	Make and respond to an expanding range of simple requests related to everyday activities.	Can ask basic questions about colour, size, price etc. when shopping.	30	A2 (30–35)
		Can make requests related to immediate needs using basic fixed expressions.	30	A2 (30–35)
		Can ask for and provide things using simple phrases.	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can ask about the location of places in a town, using simple language.	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can express their likes and dislikes in relation to familiar topics using simple language.	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can make simple purchases by stating what is wanted and asking for the price.	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can handle common everyday transactions (e.g. buying a ticket).	32	A2 (30–35)
		Can decline offers using basic fixed expressions.	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can make simple transactions in shops, post offices and banks.	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can answer simple questions about quantities and amounts, given help with vocabulary.	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can agree or refuse to lend things using basic fixed expressions.	34	A2 (30–35)
		Can make simple requests to have or do something in relation to common everyday activities.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can refuse requests politely, using simple language.	35	A2 (30–35)
	Give an expanding range of simple warnings, apologies and cautions.	Can make and accept a simple apology.	31	A2 (30–35)
IV. Sharing information	Ask for and give information about immediate needs and some feelings related to common everyday activities.	Can use brief, everyday expressions to describe wants and needs, and request information.	28	A1 (22–29)
		Can express basic intentions with simple time markers (e.g. ‘tomorrow’).	30	A2 (30–35)
		Can express their likes and dislikes in relation to familiar topics using simple language.	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can use brief, everyday expressions to ask for and give personal details.	32	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe skills and abilities using simple language.	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can ask simple questions about quantities and amounts.	33	A2 (30–35)

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
IV. Sharing information (cont.)	Ask for and give information about immediate needs and some feelings related to common everyday activities.	Can exchange simple information on everyday topics, provided the other person speaks slowly and clearly and is prepared to help.	34	A2 (30–35)
		Can give simple opinions using basic fixed expressions.	34	A2 (30–35)
		Can say what they like and dislike.	34	A2 (30–35)
		Can express general preferences using basic fixed expressions.	34	A2 (30–35)
		Can answer simple questions about their life and experiences.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can ask and talk about very basic symptoms and ailments (e.g. cold, flu).	36	A2+ (36–42)
	Give simple descriptions of concrete objects, people or experiences in a few short sentences.	Can describe an object using simple language.	29	A1 (22–29)
		Can describe a person's hobbies and activities using simple language.	30	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe their daily routines in a simple way.	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe common everyday objects using simple language.	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can give a simple description of their school or workplace.	32	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe their family, living conditions, education and present or most recent job.	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe basic activities or events that are happening at the time of speaking.	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can make simple references to the past using 'was/were'.	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe their home town or city using simple language.	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe the position of things in a picture using a range of fixed expressions	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe people's everyday lives using a short series of simple phrases and sentences.	34	A2 (30–35)

Reading

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand short, personal social messages (such as invitations, thanks, apologies, quick updates and arrangements) within predictable contexts of daily experience.	Can understand short, simple messages on postcards, emails and social networks.	31	A2 (30–35)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand short, simple, clearly sequenced instructions for familiar everyday situations.	Can follow basic instructions on how to play a simple board game, if supported by pictures.	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can understand simple instructions on everyday equipment (e.g. cash machines).	34	A2 (30–35)
		Can follow a basic sequence of events in a simple text on a familiar topic.	36	A2+ (36–42)
III. Getting things done	Get information from simple formatted texts (such as forms, tables, charts, schedules and directories).	Can understand a simple work schedule.	30	A2 (30–35)
		Can extract specific information (e.g. facts and numbers) from simple informational texts related to everyday life (e.g. posters, leaflets).	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can find specific, predictable information in everyday materials (e.g. menus, timetables).	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can understand simple questions in questionnaires on familiar topics.	31	A2 (30–35)
		Can understand a simple payslip, listing earnings and basic deductions.	36	A2+ (36–42)
	Get information from short business or service texts (such as brochures, notices, form letters and flyers).	Can understand simple descriptions of places.	27	A1 (22–29)
		Can understand the general meaning of short, simple informational material and descriptions if there is visual support.	34	A2 (30–35)
IV. Comprehending information	Understand the purpose, main idea, key information and some details in simple, short texts related to everyday familiar and personally relevant situations and topics.	Can understand familiar phrases in a simple text.	29	A1 (22–29)
		Can get the gist of short, simple narratives, with visual support.	32	A2 (30–35)
		Can read a simple text and extract factual details.	35	A2 (30–35)
	Access simple standard reference texts (such as print or online bilingual dictionaries and encyclopedias).	Can translate simple words and phrases with the help of a bilingual dictionary.	29*	A1 (22–29)
		Can identify key information in short, simple factual texts from the headings and pictures.	35	A2 (30–35)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Writing

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Convey short, personal and informal social messages on topics related to familiar everyday situations (such as invitations, thanks, updates, cancellations and apologies).	Can write short, simple notes, emails and postings to friends.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can write times using both digits and words.	29	A1 (22-29)
		Can write simple sentences about what they and other people do.	30	A2 (30-35)
		Can write very short, simple sentences about their feelings.	32	A2 (30-35)
		Can engage in basic social communication online (e.g. a simple message on a virtual card for a special occasion, sharing news and making/confirming arrangements to meet).	33	A2 (30-35)
II. Reproducing information	Copy or record a range of information from short texts for personal use.	Can copy out short texts in printed or clearly handwritten format.	32	A2 (30-35)
III. Getting things done	Complete short, simple forms that require basic personal or familiar information and some responses to simple questions.	Can write simple sentences about what they and other people do.	30	A2 (30-35)
		Can write simple plans and arrangements on a calendar or in a diary.	31	A2 (30-35)
		Can give personal details in written form in a limited way.	31	A2 (30-35)
		Can write very short, basic directions.	32	A2 (30-35)
	Write short, simple business or service messages.	Can write simple sentences about someone's work and duties.	31	A2 (30-35)
IV. Sharing information	Write a few sentences to describe a familiar person, object, place, situation or event.	Can write simple sentences about someone's life and routines.	28	A1 (22-29)
		Can describe the position of things in a picture using a few simple fixed expressions.	29	A1 (22-29)
		Can write simple sentences about a familiar object.	29	A1 (22-29)
		Can write a few basic sentences to introduce someone and give basic personal information about them.	31	A2 (30-35)
		Can write a simple description of a room, house or apartment.	31	A2 (30-35)
		Can write simple sentences about what they or other people can or can't do.	31	A2 (30-35)
		Can write short, basic descriptions of everyday activities, given a model.	33	A2 (30-35)
		Can write short texts about their likes and dislikes using basic fixed expressions.	34	A2 (30-35)
		Can write short descriptive texts (4-6 sentences) on familiar personal topics (e.g. family, possessions), given a model.	34	A2 (30-35)
		Can write short texts describing favourite objects, possessions or household pets.	36	A2+ (36-42)

Stage I – Benchmark 4

Listening

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand short social exchanges containing introductions, casual small talk and leave-taking.	Can understand who a phone call is intended for.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can follow a simple conversation or narrative about familiar, everyday activities.	36	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand standard speech on familiar matters, with some repetition or reformulation.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can make basic inferences in simple conversations on familiar everyday topics.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand enough to manage simple routine exchanges without undue effort.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand basic information in a work-related phone call.	42	A2+ (36–42)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand common, sequentially presented instructions and directions related to familiar, everyday situations of personal relevance.	Can understand simple requests or instructions to carry out concrete work-related tasks.	34	A2 (30–35)
		Can understand simple information about work activities.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can understand enough to respond to direct requests expressed slowly and clearly.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can follow the sequence of events in a short, simple dialogue or narrative.	37	A2+ (36–42)
III. Getting things done	Understand short communication intended to influence or persuade others in familiar, everyday situations.	Can recognise some basic fixed expressions to describe products or services, given help with vocabulary.	34	A2 (30–35)
		Can follow the main points in a simple audio recording, if provided with written supporting material.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand simple, factual information in a work-related video.	42	A2+ (36–42)

Listening

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
IV. Comprehending information	Understand short descriptive or narrative communication on topics of personal relevance.	Can understand short, basic descriptions of familiar topics and situations, if delivered slowly and clearly.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can identify specific information in short, simple dialogues in which speakers make arrangements to do something, if spoken slowly and clearly.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can get the gist of short, simple stories if told slowly and clearly.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can identify specific events from short spoken descriptions.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can generally identify the topic of discussion around them when conducted slowly and clearly.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand the key details of hotel, restaurant, and transport reservations.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can derive the probable meaning of simple, unknown words from short, familiar contexts.	41	A2+ (36–42)

Speaking

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Use a range of courtesy formulas and some casual small talk in short, one-on-one or small group interactions.	Can ask and answer questions about what they do at work and in their free time.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can make small talk using simple language, given a model.	36	A2+ (36–42)
		Can ask someone simple questions about their life and experiences.	36	A2+ (36–42)
		Can confirm information using some simple fixed expressions.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can initiate, maintain and close simple, restricted face-to-face conversations.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can discuss what to do in the evening or at the weekend.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can participate in short conversations in routine contexts on topics of interest.	41	A2+ (36–42)
	Participate in very short, simple phone calls.	Can introduce themselves on the phone and close a simple call.	33	A2 (30–35)
		Can leave simple phone messages using fixed expressions.	36	A2+ (36–42)
		Can make a hotel, restaurant, or transportation reservation on the phone.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can cancel a hotel, restaurant, or transportation reservation on the phone.	41	A2+ (36–42)
II. Giving instructions	Give a set of simple, common, routine instructions and directions to a familiar person.	Can give simple instructions to complete a basic task, given a model.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can give a simple description of how to carry out an everyday process (e.g. a recipe).	40	A2+ (36–42)
III. Getting things done	Make and respond to a range of requests and offers (such as getting assistance, and asking for, offering, accepting or rejecting goods or services.)	Can ask for and provide everyday goods and services.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can communicate in routine tasks requiring simple, direct exchanges of information.	36	A2+ (36–42)
		Can deal with practical everyday demands, exchanging straightforward factual information.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can get information from a tourist office of a straightforward, non-specialised nature.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can give basic advice using simple language.	39	A2+ (36–42)

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
III. Getting things done (cont.)	Make and respond to a range of requests and offers (such as getting assistance, and asking for, offering, accepting or rejecting goods or services.)	Can ask for and give or refuse permission.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can give someone the details needed to make hotel, restaurant, or transport reservations.	41	A2+ (36–42)
		Can make simple future arrangements and plans with reference to a diary or schedule.	42	A2+ (36–42)
IV. Sharing information	Ask for and give information about needs and feelings related to common everyday activities.	Can express how they feel in simple terms.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can ask and answer questions about habits and routines.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can ask and answer questions about basic plans and intentions.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can ask and answer questions about past times and past activities.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can explain what they like or dislike about something.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can ask about someone's work experience or education using simple language.	42	A2+ (36–42)
	Give brief descriptions of personal experiences, situations or simple processes, such as getting goods or services.	Can use a limited range of fixed expressions to describe objects, possessions, or products.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe a travel experience with a few very basic stock phrases.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can describe everyday activities in town (e.g. buying food at the supermarket, borrowing a book from the library) using simple language.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can give an extended description of everyday topics (e.g. people, places, experiences).	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can talk about plans for the near future in a simple way.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can describe plans and arrangements.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can talk about past events or experiences, using simple language	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can tell a story or describe something in a simple list of points.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can answer simple questions about work experience or education using simple language.	41	A2+ (36–42)
		Can give a short, basic description of events and activities.	42	A2+ (36–42)

Reading

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Understand simple personal social messages (such as invitations, thanks, apologies, quick updates and arrangements) within predictable contexts of daily experience.	Can understand short, simple personal emails and letters.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand basic factual information in work-related emails.	40	A2+ (36–42)
II. Comprehending instructions	Understand short, simple, clearly sequenced instructions and instructional texts for familiar everyday situations.	Can follow a simple series of written instructions to carry out a task.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can understand rules and regulations (e.g. safety) if expressed in simple language.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand the instructions to buy tickets online.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can follow the sequence of actions or events in a text on a familiar everyday topic.	41	A2+ (36–42)
III. Getting things done	Get information from simple formatted texts (such as forms, tables, schedules and directories).	Can understand a simple payslip, listing earnings and basic deductions.	36	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand reports of travel delays and cancellations.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand short, simple user tips in a software interface.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand a job application form requiring basic professional information.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand information in a simple work-related diagram or chart.	41	A2+ (36–42)
	Get information from short business or service texts (such as brochures, notices, form letters and flyers).	Can identify specific information in simple letters, brochures and short articles.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand simple meeting titles in a work-related calendar.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand a short, simple cover letter from a job applicant.	40	A2+ (36–42)

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
IV. Comprehending information	Understand the purpose, main idea, key information and specific details in simple, short texts related to everyday familiar and personally relevant situations and topics.	Can identify basic biographical information in short simple texts about other people.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can understand short, simple narrative texts.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can make basic inferences from simple information in a short text.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand basic opinions expressed in simple language in short texts.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can identify basic similarities and differences in the facts between two short simple texts on the same familiar topic, if supported by pictures and questions.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can scan a simple text, identifying the main topic(s).	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand simple details in informational texts (blogs, websites, catalogues, etc.).	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can understand a short, simple professional profile.	41	A2+ (36–42)
		Can identify the main topic and related ideas in a simple structured text.	42	A2+ (36–42)
	Access simple standard reference texts (such as dictionaries and encyclopedias).	Can find the correct meaning of a word in a bilingual dictionary.	37*	A2+ (36–42)

* GSE Learning Objectives with an asterisk indicate provisional levels.

Writing

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
I. Interacting with others	Convey short, personal, informal social messages on topics related to familiar everyday situations (such as invitations, thanks, updates, cancellations and apologies).	Can write a simple text (e.g. an invitation to a party) containing key information, given a model.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can write short, simple notes, emails and messages relating to everyday matters.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write very simple personal emails/letters expressing thanks and apology.	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a simple email/letter in response to a request for information.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can use appropriate openings and endings in simple informal emails.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write simple texts or emails making arrangements to meet, given a model.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a simple email issuing a work-related invitation.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a simple email accepting a work-related invitation.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a simple work-related email/letter expressing thanks.	41	A2+ (36–42)
II. Reproducing information	Copy or record an expanded range of information from short texts for personal use.	Can pick out and reproduce key words and phrases or short sentences from a short text within the learner's limited competence and experience.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write basic instructions with a simple list of points.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write simple lists as part of a work-related task.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can rewrite a simple text to correct mistakes.	42	A2+ (36–42)
III. Getting things done	Complete simple forms that require basic personal or familiar information and some responses to simple questions.	Can complete a form with basic professional information.	35	A2 (30–35)
		Can write a description of a simple everyday process (e.g. a recipe).	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a brief summary of their own personal details, e.g. for a business card.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a short, simple email/letter asking for information about an apartment or house to rent.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write simple sentences about their educational background and present or past job.	41	A2+ (36–42)
		Can complete a simple form asking for medical information.	41	A2+ (36–42)
		Can complete a simple job application form requiring basic professional information.	42	A2+ (36–42)

CLB Competency Area	CLB Competency Statement	GSE Learning Objective	GSE level	CEFR level
III. Getting things done (cont.)	Write simple business or service messages.	Can ask for personal details in written form in a limited way.	36	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a simple email to confirm information about a meeting (times, dates, etc).	38	A2+ (36–42)
		Can place a simple written order for goods or services.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a simple email/letter in response to a request for information.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can post short, simple work-related messages on professional social networks.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write basic sentences comparing products, people or places.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write basic sentences about a work-related process.	42	A2+ (36–42)
IV. Sharing information	Write a short paragraph to describe a familiar situation, event, personal experience or future plan.	Can give an example of something in a very simple text using 'like' or 'for example'.	34	A2 (30–35)
		Can write short, simple descriptions of people's physical appearance using basic connectors, given prompts or a model.	36	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a short description of familiar activities, given visual support.	37	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write short basic descriptions of past events and activities.	39	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write simple sentences about a future trip or event.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a simple story or description of an event using basic time expressions.	40	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write descriptions of everyday personal experiences.	41	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write about everyday things (e.g. people, places, job, study) in linked sentences.	41	A2+ (36–42)
		Can make basic informal suggestions in writing.	42	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write simple texts giving key information about their culture (e.g. food, national holidays, festivals).	42	A2+ (36–42)
		Can write a short description of a trip or event.	42	A2+ (36–42)

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